Damien Dormal

Staff Software Engineer | damien.dormal@pm.me | +61 459 352 671 | Margaret River, AU

Summary

Pragmatic Staff Software Engineer with 15+ years of experience building and scaling distributed systems in fintech. Deep expertise in card issuing platforms, IDV/KYC, and bank/network integrations powering millions of customers at Cash App and Square. Product-minded technical leader who bridges engineering, compliance, and business stakeholders. Proven track record as both IC and Engineering Manager. Proficient with AI-augmented engineering workflows.

Skills

- **Languages**: Kotlin, Java, Python, JavaScript, Ruby, Scala
- **Backend & Infrastructure**: Kafka, gRPC, REST APIs, GraphQL, Temporal, Node.js, Rails
- **Databases**: MySQL, PostgreSQL, Redis, MongoDB
- **Cloud & DevOps**: AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD
- **Domain Expertise**: Distributed Systems, Card Issuance, IDV/KYC, Bank & Network Integration

Work Experience

Cash App / Block **Remote**
Staff Software Engineer Jul 2024 — Mar 2026
- Led the accounts stream for Block's VISA DPS integration, designing issuer-agnostic APIs and executing a 34M-record data migration
- Architected a scalable program construct to manage Block's growing card issuing portfolio across multiple sponsor banks
- Coordinated 4+ teams on Bancorp reporting compliance, securing bank approval and unblocking the DPS launch timeline
- Championed AI-augmented engineering workflows, running weekly AI mob sessions and driving large-scale codebase refactors with agentic tooling

Cash App / Block **Remote**
Engineering Manager Jun 2022 — Jul 2024
- Founded and grew the New Markets team into a T-shaped org owning account management and card program infrastructure (3-5 engineers)
- Led the 3DS/ACS initiative end-to-end — from PCI DSS certification through network integration to production rollout for Cash App and Square Card
- Designed and built the Card Programs Store, a centralized service to manage Block's growing portfolio of card programs across issuers
- Drove KYC modernization and supported new card program launches across multiple geographies (US, Canada, UK)
- Authored the team's strategic roadmap and made the business case for team expansion

Cash App / Block **Remote**
Staff Software Engineer May 2021 — Jun 2022
- Enabled the launch of Cash Teen / Sponsored accounts across issuing programs, driving key changes in the KYC pipeline
- Designed a simplified KYC storage architecture, replacing a complex multi-service proxy flow and enabling partner bank reporting
- Extended the accounts platform to support multi-issuer customer accounts for both Cash App and Square

Envato **Remote**
Lead Developer (Acting) Dec 2019 — May 2021
- Designed and developed a new API to distribute content across the organisation, enabling downstream teams to consume assets programmatically
- Led decomposition of a monolith application into services, extracting key functionalities into independently deployable microservices
- Led infrastructure and DevOps improvements within the group, organising and facilitating monthly infrastructure catchups

Locomote **Remote**
Lead Software Engineer Feb 2016 — Apr 2019
- Developed the booking tool (Node.js) and travel management platform (Rails) serving enterprise customers
- Transformed the booking tool to support multiple booking APIs, enabling the platform to aggregate travel suppliers
- Supported engineers and hired new staff, improving developer engagement through cross-team meetings

Moko Social Media **Perth, WA**
Software Engineer Feb 2015 — Feb 2016
- Built the API for Speakiesy, an intramural social app launched to 100+ college campuses (Rails)
- Introduced new DevOps strategy using Docker and AWS ECS, modernizing the deployment pipeline

Cinglevue **Perth, WA**
Lead Software Engineer Mar 2012 — Jun 2014
- Developed the system back-end (REST API) and front-end (Backbone.js, Bootstrap), establishing BDD testing with Cucumber and Selenium
- Created a proof of concept for a new client-side stack (Backbone.js, Handlebars.js, Require.js) that became the company standard

iiNet **Perth, WA**
Software Engineer Apr 2011 — Mar 2012

Steria **Brussels, Belgium**
Software Engineer Sep 2007 — Oct 2010

Education

HEB ESI — **Brussels, Belgium**
Bachelor — Sep 2004 — Jun 2007
- > 80%

Profiles

GitHub *damsonn*	github.com/damsonn	**LinkedIn** *damiendormal*	linkedin.com/in/damiendormal

Certifications

- **Neural Networks and Deep Learning** : Coursera

Projects

VISA DPS Integration
Led accounts stream for Block's migration to VISA DPS as a direct issuer processor, designing issuer-agnostic APIs and coordinating Bancorp compliance across 4+ teams

Card Programs Store
Designed and built a centralized service to manage Block's growing card issuing portfolio with APIs, datastore, and admin panel, refactoring shard allocation logic out of multiple legacy systems

3DS / Access Control Server
Led the end-to-end 3DS/ACS initiative for Cash App and Square Card — from PCI DSS/3DS certification through network infrastructure to production rollout